



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Upper Valley Christian School

School Website: <https://www.uvcschool.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Upper Valley Christian School (Leavenworth, WA, 98826) (UVCS) presents a THEOLOGICAL and CLASSICAL orientation per public-facing materials. The school self-describes as offering Classical Christian Education, integrates a biblically-grounded worldview, and foregrounds the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) alongside Great Books, paideia language, and liturgical life (e.g., chapel, statement of faith). Mission statements foreground partnership with families in a Christ-centered, classical education intended to form virtuous, thinking students who live for the glory of God and the good of others. These elements align UVCS with a Classical education posture in the knowledge base, particularly through explicit references to Trivium, Great Books, virtue formation, theology, liturgy, and a communal/church-aligned life of learning. Public materials repeatedly emphasize formation of character, the objective truth of biblical truth, and a community rooted in Christian worship and doctrinal commitments. This combination supports a CLASSICAL classification across the rubric.

Key public signals include: explicit Classical Christian framing (Trivium, Great Books, Paideia), a biblically grounded worldview, liturgical/covenantal elements (Chapel, Statement of Faith), and a mission centered on virtue and wisdom within a Christian frame. The presence of a clearly defined K–12 program with Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric tracks (and rhetoric in the 9–12 program) further anchors UVCS in the classical pedagogical tradition, while formal aspects like “our mission ... Christ-centered education, in the classical tradition” and explicit doctrinal commitments strengthen the religious/metaphysical foundation. Taken together, the school demonstrates a coherent classical education profile rather than a partial or secular reform approach.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - UVCS presents Classical Christian Education with a biblical worldview (Paideia) and Great Books, explicitly tying learning to a Christian framework. This framing appears in the “What is Classical Education?” content, which describes biblical worldview, Paideia, the Great Books, and the Trivium as foundational to the educational approach. - The school’s public materials frame education as Christ-centered and God-oriented, including statements of faith and mission focused on God’s glory and the good of others. - The chapel and liturgical aspects are indicated in programmatic materials and site navigation, signaling liturgical/community practices as integral to education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: biblical worldview, Paideia, Great Books, Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), theology, Christ-centered, statement of faith, liturgy/chapel, virtues (seven Christian virtues), worship, sacred texts. Cited elements include Paideia and Great Books on the “What is Classical Education?” page and explicit vow to a Christ-centered education in mission statements. - Negative keywords found: None explicit in UVCS public materials; the negative signals in the Classical

rubric (relativism, secular humanism, moral neutrality) do not appear in UVCS materials. The lexicon doc lists negatives to watch for, but UVCS content aligns with classical/religious framing rather than secular alternatives.

Why this rating - UVCS explicitly anchors education in biblical truth and theology (Statement of Faith), highlights liturgical life (Chapel), and foregrounds a Paideia/GREAT BOOKS approach under a Christ-centered framework. These signals satisfy the Positive keyword indicators for religious/metaphysical foundations and show no counter-signals in public materials. This supports a CLASSICAL classification for Element 1.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission emphasizes forming students “to live purposefully and intelligently for the glory of God and for the good of others” within a classical tradition. This articulates a formation-oriented telos beyond job-preparation. - The public materials emphasize the classical mission and the liberal-arts orientation via Paideia and Great Books, with statements that stress formation/virtue rather than merely information transfer. The page describing “What is Classical Education?” frames education as a pathway to virtue, wisdom, and the pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty. - The public copy positions education as forming human excellence and character, not just content delivery. The mission/vision statements foreground a Christian, classical telos rather than workforce-oriented aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, Paideia, Great Books, classical mission, telos, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty, contemplation. The UVCS materials frequently reflect formation-oriented language and a classical telos (e.g., “classical tradition,” “glory of God,” and “good of others” in mission). - Negative keywords found: none (no explicit emphasis on workforce-readiness, 21st-century skills, or other modern-utility framing). The content consistently foregrounds formation and virtue rather than mere job-readiness.

Why this rating - The school’s stated purpose centers on formation, virtue, wisdom, and the real existence of truth/goodness/beauty within a biblical framework. The absence of a dominant workforce-prep or utilitarian framing, and the presence of classical telos language, justify CLASSICAL for Element 2.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The core curriculum explicitly uses the Trivium: Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric as central explanatory tools, labeled as the heart of classical education. This is repeatedly described in UVCS content. - The site references Great Books and a Great Conversation approach, indicating engagement with canonical, historical texts. - The curriculum language includes coverage of Latin/Greek/classical languages, Western civilization/history, and a liberal-arts orientation, with the Trivium as organizing framework. - The public materials describe a Christ-centered curriculum and time-tested approach that blends classical content (grammar/logic/rhetoric) with a Christian framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: liberal arts, Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books, primary sources, classics, Homer/Plato/Augustine/Shakespeare, Latin/Greek, history/Western civilization, narration/recitation, sacred art, hymns. The UVCS curriculum materials explicitly mention Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric and Great Books, and the Great Books emphasis is clear. - Negative keywords found: none of the negated signals (e.g., social-studies-first framing or project-based dominance) appear in UVCS public materials. The public-facing content emphasizes history/Western civilization and classical methods.

Why this rating - UVCS’s curriculum centers on the Trivium, Great Books, and a liberal-arts approach with explicit reference to history and Western civilization, aligning with classical-curriculum indicators and counter-signaling non-classical elements. This supports CLASSICAL for Element 3.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower-school practices emphasize singing, chanting, recitation, memory work, and memorization as a regular learning method. This is a hallmark of classical pedagogy and scholé (restful, contemplative learning) in early grades. - Upper-school pedagogy is described through a progression to more analytic methods and rhetoric, with mentions of the Trivium in the curriculum, and a path toward rhetoric and oratory in the high school. The presence of grammar/logic/rhetoric tracks implies an expectation of higher-order discussion and rhetorical training. - The published “What is Classical Education?” content signals emphasis on forming reasoning through Trivium, Great Books, and a liturgical/paideia approach; it also notes the use of contemplative and elevated aims in education. While the site doesn’t always spell out every pedagogical activity, the alignment with scholé, memory work, recension, and ritual content is evident. - The Classical lexicon/element document lists pedagogical signals such as Socratic seminars, narration, chanting, and memory work as classical practices, with cautionary notes about non-classical approaches (e.g., excessive project-based or constructivist emphasis). UVCS content shows alignment with memory, recitation, and liturgical rhythm, and a trajectory toward rhetoric in the upper grades.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: recitation, chanting, memory work, pedagogy centered on the Trivium, scholé, contemplative learning, seminars, Paideia-style approach, rhetoric training, public speaking, Great Books engagement, worship/ritual integration. Positive signals are found across lower- and upper-grade materials and the Trivium/curriculum descriptions. - Negative keywords found: The site does not prominently emphasize experiential/project-based-only approaches; the absence of those explicit signals in UVCS public materials supports a classical pedagogy reading. The lexicon notes as negative signals include project-based learning dominance; these are not foregrounded in UVCS materials.

Why this rating - The site demonstrates a structured progression from memorization/singing and memory work in the early years to Socratic/seminar-like discourse and rhetoric preparation in the upper grades, consistent with classical pedagogy. While explicit “Socratic seminars” are not described in a single public-page paragraph, the Trivium-based progression and the documented lower-school practices support a CLASSICAL rating for Element 4.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - UVCS emphasizes “direct teacher instruction in small classroom settings” and “curriculum and instruction are presented from a Christian perspective, modeled by staff and explicitly taught to students.” This signals a strong, skilled teaching corps actively shaping student formation. - Public materials also discuss the dedicated faculty in relation to forming virtue and guiding students, with references to “dedicated faculty” and a small student-to-teacher ratio described in the broader materials. This aligns with a classical portrait of teachers as mentors and living curriculum. - The site highlights an active, mission-driven faculty, and the “Our Team” page exists as part of the public site, signaling a recognized faculty presence and a perceived living curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: dedicated faculty, small class sizes, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, mentors, guides, virtue model. The Six Elements lexicon explicitly includes “portrait of a teacher,” “living curriculum,” and “collegial culture” as signaling classical faculty culture; UVCS site reflects many of these signals in practice. - Negative keywords found: none evident in public UVCS content; the negative signals in the lexicon (e.g., “certification-driven” or “facilitators on the side”) do not appear in UVCS’s public-facing materials.

Why this rating - The public materials present faculty as central to the school’s education, with small-class environments, explicit teacher-led instruction, and a living-curriculum framing. These align with CLASSICAL expectations for Element 5.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - UVCS frames itself as a partner with families in a Christ-centered, classical education, explicitly stating mission to “partner with families” and to work with parents as co-teachers in forming virtue and

character. This aligns with the classical parent-community partnership ideal. - The site highlights parental involvement through admissions, visits, and family engagement in school life (e.g., events, open houses, parent/teacher interactions, and accessible contact). The site navigation includes “Mission,” “Playschool,” “Chapel,” “Events,” “Admissions,” etc., signaling an open, family-facing environment. - The lexicon/element document emphasizes parent partnerships, parent formation, and family involvement as core to classical education; UVCS materials echo and operationalize these commitments.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, reading groups, seminars, classical book clubs, open campus, parent covenant, family involvement, parent presence at events. The UVCS materials reference partnership with families and family engagement through mission and program design. - Negative keywords found: none evident in UVCS public materials; the negative signals from the Six Elements lexicon (consumer language, parent-as-customer) do not appear to characterize UVCS’s publicly shared materials.

Why this rating - UVCS publicly promotes parent partnership, family engagement, and open, participatory school life. The presence of formal mission language and family-facing program components aligns with CLASSICAL for Element 6.

Aggregate assessment - All six categories meet the classical criteria according to the presented evidence and keyword alignment. The school’s public materials strongly reflect a Classical orientation (Classical/-Somewhat Classical/Not Classical rubric). Given the robust classical signals across all six categories (Religious foundations, Purpose, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents/Community), UVCS WA 98826 earns a firm CLASSICAL rating.

What Would Move the Needle

- No major needle-moving changes are required for a CLASSICAL overall rating. If desired, minor enhancements could include explicit, on-site articulation of “Great Conversations” or iterative exemplars of Socratic pedagogy in upper grades, and continued public emphasis on formation/freedom within a classical framework to reinforce the existing signals.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.